



Standard Operating Procedure

Blood Product Transfusion: Anaesthesia Record 730.4 prescribing and documentation requirements

Scope

Site	Service/Department/Unit	Disciplines
SCGOPHCG	Theatres and procedural areas ONLY	Medical & Nursing, Anaesthetic Technicians (AT), Clinical Perfusionists (CP)

Introduction

Prescription of medications and fluids for patients under the care of an anaesthetist in a theatre or procedural area setting, is vastly different to that of other wards/departments. This includes blood and blood product transfusion. The variations of practice require standard operating procedures to ensure that blood and blood products are prescribed, recorded, and managed in accordance with Australian and New Zealand Society of Blood Transfusion guidelines and requirements of the Australian Red Cross Lifeblood, whilst considering the differing processes and disciplines involved.

This SOP relates to blood product transfusion to patients in the operating theatre suite or procedural area where an Anaesthesia Record 730.4 is being actively utilised in patient monitoring/medication administration.

Risk Statement

Non-compliance with this procedure will:

Breach legislative requirements	☐	Impact on Patient Quality of Care	☐
Breach National/State/Hospital Policy	☒	Impact on Patient Safety	☒
Breach professional standards	☐	Misconduct	☐
Breach SCGOPHCG Mission & Values	☐	Staff Safety	☐
Other:	☐		

Procedure

Any staff member involved in the checking and administration of blood products MUST be acting within their scope of practice and have completed transfusion education and competencies defined within their role.

Patients undergoing surgery or procedure where there is a high risk of bleeding should have a valid group and antibody screen and have had recent iron studies, with iron supplementation pre surgery where possible, or peri-op.

1.0 Transfusion Consent

Transfusion consent should be obtained PRIOR to the day of surgery via a valid Consent to Treatment (Form A).

At the time of consenting a patient for their surgery/procedure, the risks and benefits of transfusion must be discussed, and the YES box marked to indicate that they consent to the transfusion of blood and blood products. If a patient refuses, or has restricted consent to blood and blood products, the NO box should be marked and a Refusal/Restricted Consent to Blood Products (Form D) completed. This should be clearly documented on the Anaesthesia Record and/or on all handover documents related to the surgery/procedure.

Where the patient is unable to provide consent due to emergency event/intervention, this should be documented in the medical record.

2.0 Patient Identification

Patient identification should be carried out in accordance with the following:

- [SCGOPHCG Patient Identification policy](#)
- [NMHS Patient Identification and Procedure Matching policy](#)
- SCGOPHCG Removal and Replacement of Patient Identification Bands in the Operating Theatre Suite- Standard Operating Procedure

3-point patient ID check should be carried out to ensure the right patient receives the right product. Patient labels should not be placed on medical record forms or specimens unless thorough 3-point patient identification checks have been conducted.

3.0 Prescription and documentation of transfusion

As per the 'Guideline on the Anaesthesia Record 2020' produced by the Australian and New Zealand College of Anaesthetists (ANZCA) the anaesthesia record (M027)

“serves the purpose of documenting the clinical management of any patient’s care as well as guiding management. It is also a record of drug administration...”³

Documentation on the Anaesthesia Record 730.4 of blood products administered in the operating theatre suite serves as a valid blood product prescription if the following has been recorded:

- Blood product
- Volume and number of units
- Time of administration
- Transfusion reaction details and management (a [transfusion reaction and adverse incident report](#) form must also be completed and sent to the transfusion medicine unit)

Rate of administration for blood products on an Anaesthesia Record 730.4 is “stat” unless otherwise documented.

To ensure traceability of blood products a **Blood Product Transfusion Anaesthesia Record/ EMR Record** must be utilised to record blood products transfused to the patient by attaching the relevant compatibility/product batch number label to the form, with the signatures of the two staff checking the blood products, along with the date and time.

Once a patient leaves theatre/procedural area, that is, transfers to the recovery room and/or returns to ward/department, any further blood products required MUST be prescribed and recorded on a M042 Blood Product Transfusion Form.

4.0 Blood product storage & minimising waste

Where possible, for surgeries with high risk of large blood loss, the patient should have a valid group and antibody screen specimen available on site and blood products pre-ordered to ensure timely availability of blood products when required. In this case blood products may be issued in a SCGH Theatre 6- hour red shipper with a temperature logger.

Blood products issued in a red shipper should be contained within the red shipper, zipped up, until required for transfusion. The shipper should be re-zipped if any blood products remain within it, and returned as soon as possible if not required, to the transfusion medicine unit (TMU) within the time identified on the shipper.

Any blood products issued in a blue foam esky should remain in the esky unless being transfused, and if not required, returned in the esky to TMU as soon as possible within the time identified on the esky.

Blood products transferred with a patient should occur in accordance with the [transportation of blood products with patient during inter/intra-hospital transfers](#) policy.

5.0 Critical Bleed events

In the event of a critical bleed, a single person should be in communication with TMU (extn: 34018) and provide the following:

State: Activating Critical Bleed Protocol

Clinical situation (eg. GI bleed, trauma, cardiac arrest)

Provide: Patient details

Patient location (eg. Theatre 4)

Authorising medical officer name

Contact phone number/critical bleed liaison person

Transfusion needs- consider need for FFP/ cryo/ platelets/ red cells. Please state number of units required. The scientists will not know the full extent of the circumstances and require defined product requirements.

Please contact TMU to stand down once the critical bleed event has been controlled.

Compliance, monitoring and evaluation

The SCGOPHCG Blood Management Committee is responsible for ensuring the effectiveness of this standard operating procedure and monitors compliance and appropriate use of blood products in accordance with the [National Blood Authority Patient Blood Management guidelines](#) through regular audit processes.

Related Documents

Authorising Policy and Standard/s:

- [SCGOPHCG Transfusion Policy Manual](#)

Standards, procedures, guidelines:

- [SCGOPHCG Administration and Checking of Blood Products](#)
- [ANZSBT Guidelines for the Administration of Blood Products](#)
- [Transportation of blood products with patient during inter/intra-hospital transfers](#)

Supporting documents

- Blood Product Transfusion Anaesthetics / EMR Record
- Anaesthesia Record 730.4
- M042 Blood Product Transfusion Form

References

1. Australian and New Zealand society of blood transfusion, Australian College of Nursing. Guidelines for administration of blood products (Internet). Sydney: Australian & New Zealand Society of Blood Transfusion Ltd; 2024 Jan (cited 2024 Nov 5). Available from :<https://anzsbt.org.au/wp-content/uploads/2020/03/ANZSBT-Administration-Guidelines-Revised-3rd-edition-Publication-Version-FINAL-20191002.pdf>
2. Australian Red Cross Lifeblood. Blood component information: an extension of blood component labels 2024 edition (Internet). Australia; 2024 (cited 2024 Nov 5). Available from: <https://www.lifeblood.com.au/health-professionals/learn/resource-library?page=2>
3. Australian and New Zealand College of Anaesthetists. PG06(A) Guideline on the anaesthesia record (Internet). Melbourne: 2020 (cited 2024 Nov 26). Available from: <https://www.anzca.edu.au/resources/professional-documents/guidelines/ps06-guideline-on-the-anaesthesia-record>
4. Australian and New Zealand College of Anaesthetists. PS08(A) Position statement on the assistant for the anaesthetist (Internet). Melbourne: 2016 (cited 2024 Nov 26). Available from: <https://www.anzca.edu.au/getattachment/473f7e0d-b14a-4939-aad1-034c0474c603/PS08-Statement-on-the-assistant-for-the-anaesthetist>

Authorisation & Version Control

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For full details regarding, development, review, consultation, approval, endorsement - contact the Policy Officer for the submission form

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